

“IBM will continue to invest in open source technology projects”

IBM is one of those companies that banks big on open source technology. Those at the helm know this is where the future of technology lies. **Diksha P Gupta** from *Open Source For You* spoke to **Dipankar Sarma**, distinguished engineer, Systems & Technology Labs, IBM India, to discuss the increasing demand for open source professionals and the opportunities that IBM offers them. Excerpts...



Q:What is the Linux Technology Centre at IBM all about and what are its key roles?

I work with the Linux Technology Centre, which is primarily a Linux and open source development organisation. What we do in this centre with Linux pervades across IBM products and we have a number of engineers who work in various geographies. It is a worldwide team based in many different labs across different countries.

We, in India, work on some of the key open source projects that are important from IBM's perspective. Linux and the Linux kernel are some of the areas in which we have contributed in the past. I have been a contributor to the Linux kernel myself. A lot of people at IBM in India as

well as in other parts of the world make a good amount of contributions to the Linux kernel. According to the Linux Foundation's statistics, IBM is one of the top contributors to the Linux kernel. Other than Linux, we have contributed to Eclipse, Apache as well as other open source projects, Samba being one of them. In recent times, OpenStack has become a very important project from our perspective. All of these projects are looked after by the parent organisation, Linux Technology Centre.

We work very closely with the open source community to push some of those technologies in a direction that is good for the community as well as for a lot of us who actually make use of those products.